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The BLACK TERROR

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BLACK TERROR
HEADLINERS
THE BLACK TERROR in three startling adventures:
1 "YOU'LL DIE LAUGHING"
2 "TROUBLE DOWN MEXICO WAY"
3 "THE GOLDEN DOOM"
– and many other exciting features
In this issue—
THE SCARAB
A Guest Feature
Ralph Mayo


BOB AND TIM THOUGHT THEY KNEW EVERY TWIST, TURN AND BLIND ALLEY IN ADVENTURE'S TRAIL! BUT THAT WAS BEFORE THEY SET OUT IN SEARCH OF THEMSELVES---AND GOT DRENCHED IN A CLOUDBURST OF MEXICAN PERIL!...FOLLOW THE DAUNTLESS TERROR TWINS ON THEIR GREATEST EXPLOIT!
DOUBLE TROUBLE DOWN MEXICO WAY!
1
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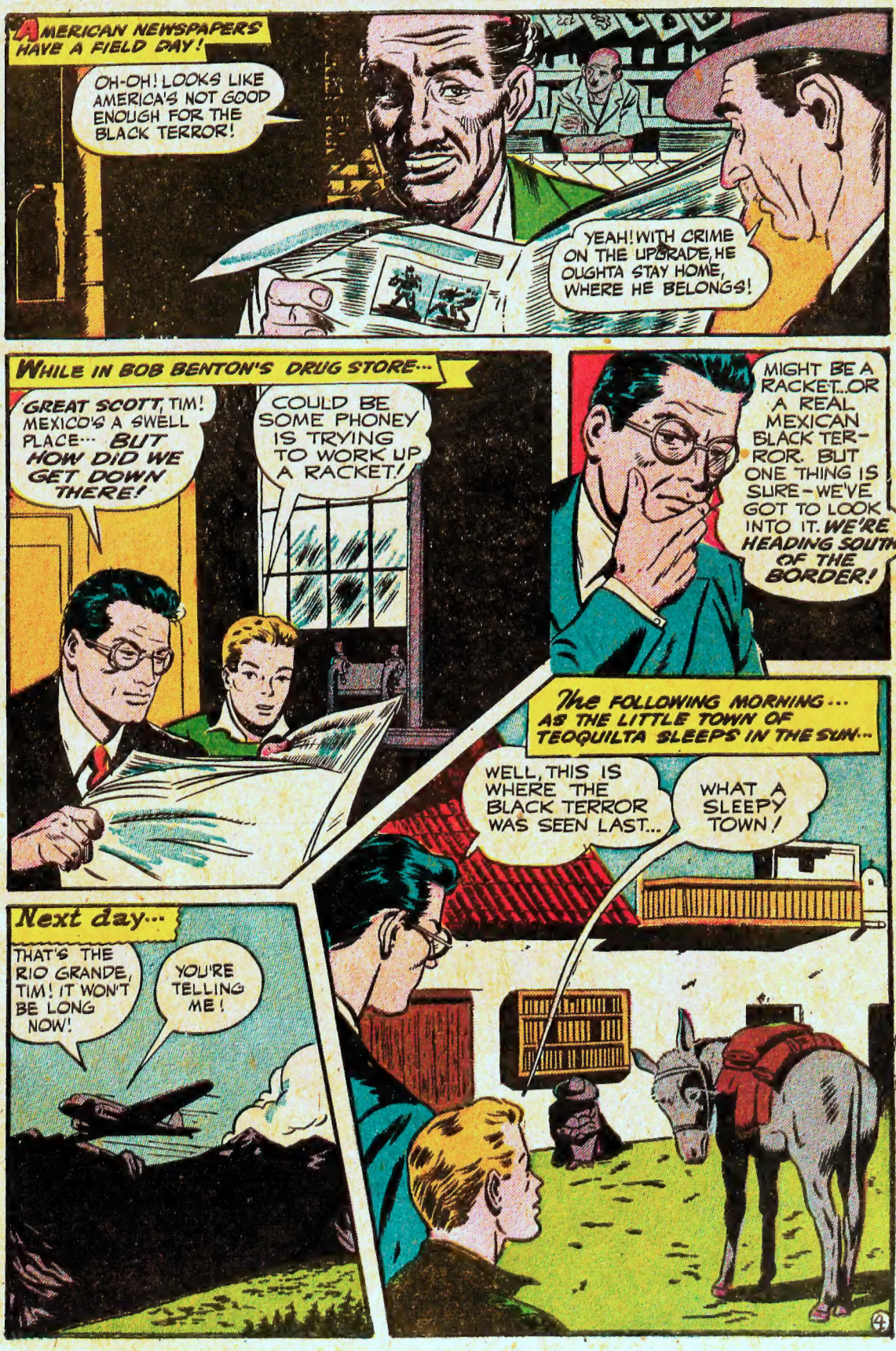
The BLACK TERROR



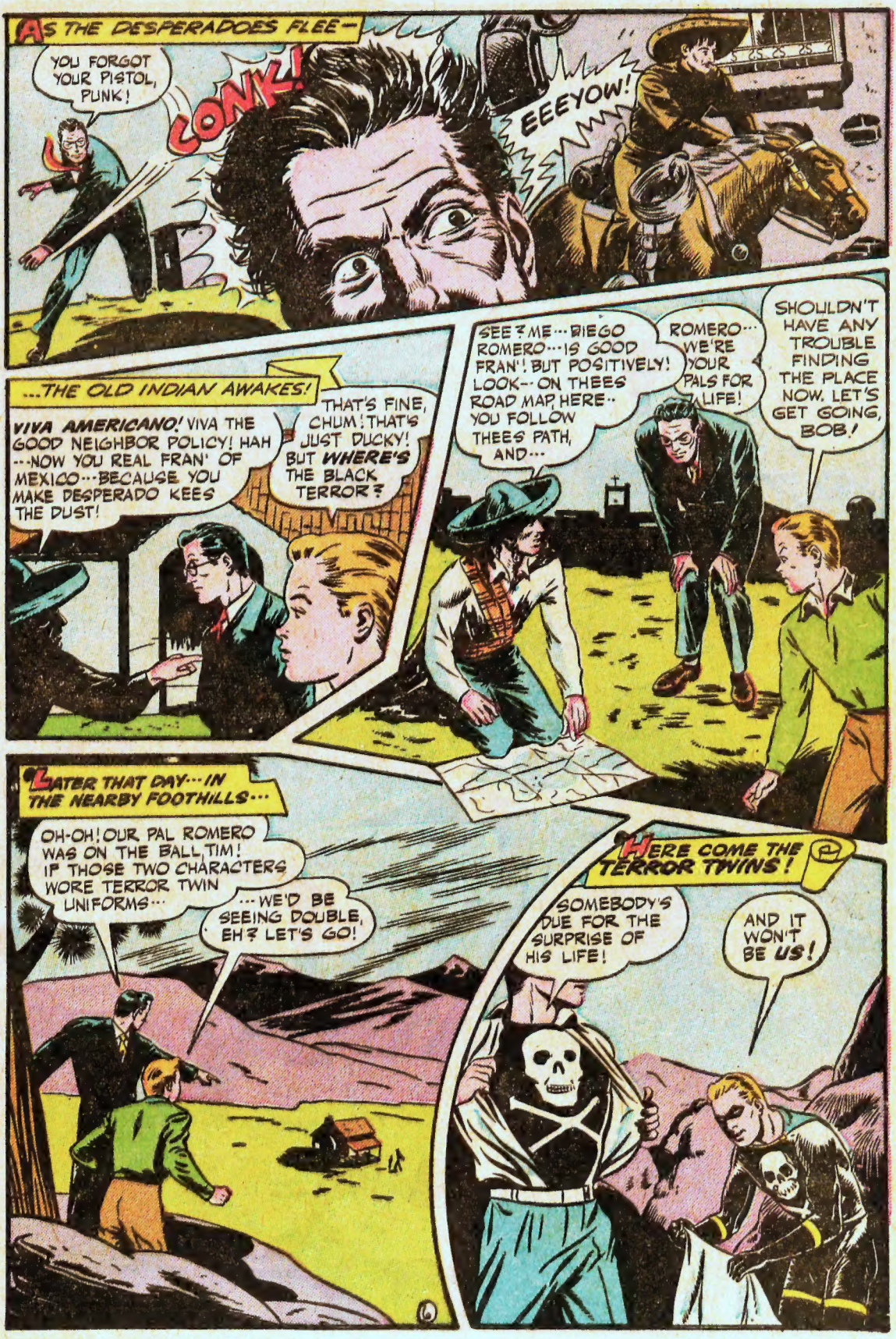





CARAMBA! THEY ROB ···KEEL!
WOW···WHAT A BREAK! A BANK STICKUP! COVER THE ENTRANCE, SPOT! I'LL SNAP THIS LAD!
Next instant···
AIEEE! IT EES THE BLACK TERROR!
HUH? THE BLACK TERROR? HOW'D HE GET TO MEXICO?
THE BLACK TERROR ···IN MEXICO! IT'S THE SCOOP OF THE CENTURY!
WHEN JOSE FERNANDO SHOOT ···HE ALWAYS KEEL!
YOU WEEL NOT SHOOT TODAY, SENOR!
YAAAGGHH!
WOW! THE BLACK TERROR KNOCKED THE BANDITS FOR A LOOP!—AND HE'S RETURNING THE MONEY!
WHAT A SCOOP!
BUT A MOMENT LATER···
HEY! WE'RE YANKS FROM BROOKLYN, U.S.A.! GIVE US A BREAK, TERROR!
SO SORREE, SEÑORS! THEES MORNING WE ARE IN ONE BEEG HURRY!
And then···
EVEN WITHOUT THE INTERVIEW ···WE'VE ACTUALLY SEEN THE BLACK TERROR IN ACTION!
AND WE'VE GOT THE PICTURES TO PROVE IT!
3

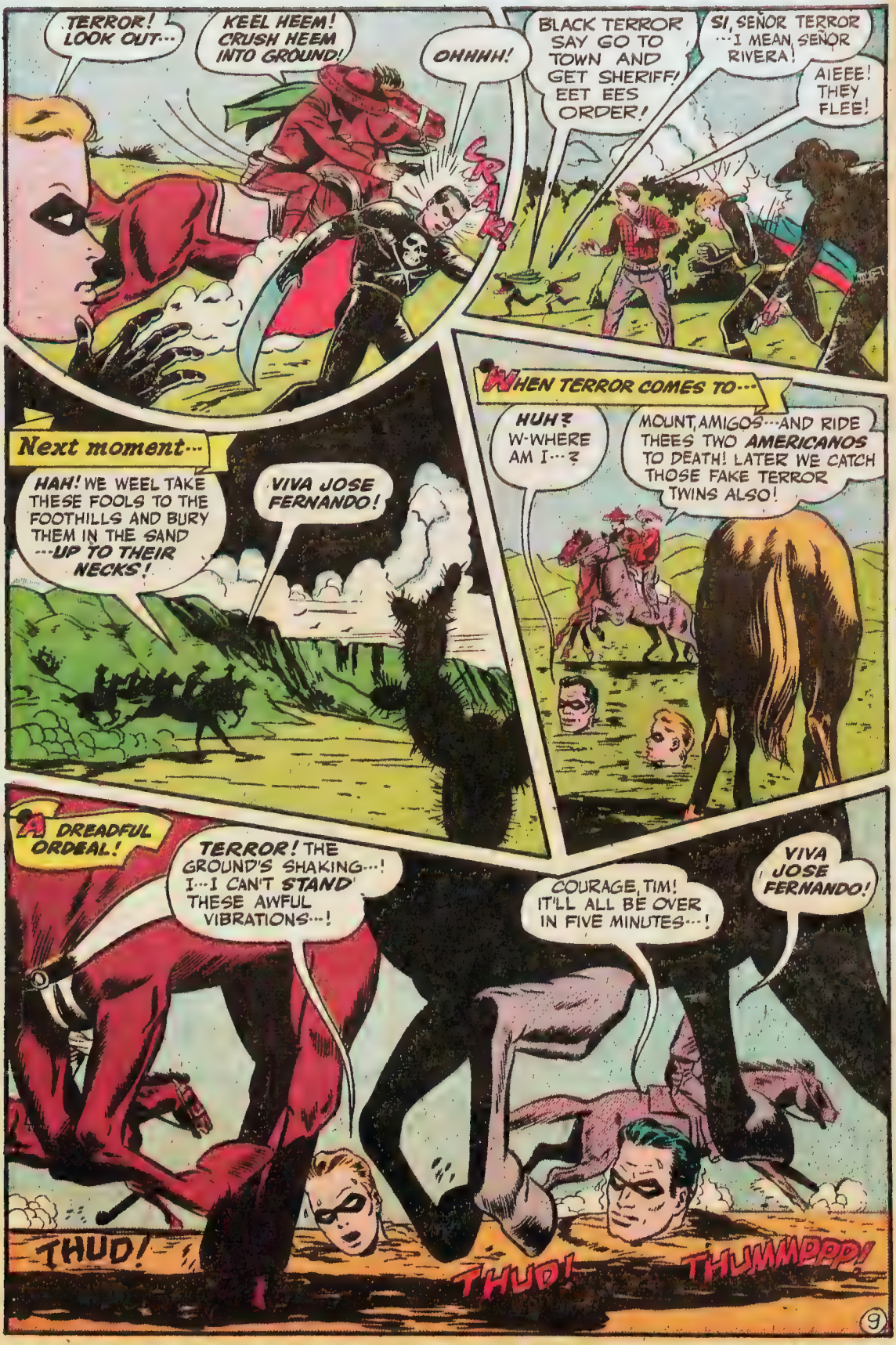

AMERICAN NEWSPAPERS HAVE A FIELD DAY!
OH-OH! LOOKS LIKE AMERICA'S NOT GOOD ENOUGH FOR THE BLACK TERROR!
YEAH! WITH CRIME ON THE UPGRADE, HE OUGHTA STAY HOME, WHERE HE BELONGS!
WHILE IN BOB BENTON'S DRUG STORE...
GREAT SCOTT, TIM! MEXICO'S A SWELL PLACE... BUT HOW DID WE GET DOWN THERE!
COULD BE SOME PHONEY IS TRYING TO WORK UP A RACKET!
MIGHT BE A RACKET...OR A REAL MEXICAN BLACK TERROR. BUT ONE THING IS SURE - WE'VE GOT TO LOOK INTO IT. WE'RE HEADING SOUTH OF THE BORDER!
The FOLLOWING MORNING... AS THE LITTLE TOWN OF TEOQUILTA SLEEPS IN THE SUN...
WELL, THIS IS WHERE THE BLACK TERROR WAS SEEN LAST...
WHAT A SLEEPY TOWN!
Next day...
THAT'S THE RIO GRANDE, TIM! IT WON'T BE LONG NOW!
YOU'RE TELLING ME!
4


SORRY TO BOTHER YOU, OLD MAN! UH··· WE'RE AMERICANOS ···AND WE'RE LOOKING FOR THE BLACK TERROR! ANY IDEA WHERE HE HANGS OUT?
EET EES VER-RY SAD, SEÑOR···BUT POOR ROMERO NOT KNOW!
BUT THE QUESTION IS OVERHEARD AND...
MANUEL···YOU HEAR HEEM, THE AMERICANO? IF HE IS FRIEND OF BLACK TERROR-HE MAKE ONE BEEG MIS-TAKE HERE!
I AM JOSE FERNANDO ···NO GRINGOS FOOL AROUND WEETH ME! WHY YOU LOOK FOR BLACK TERROR, HUH?
WHAT IS THIS···A RECEPTION COMMITTEE?
I, JOSE FERNANDO, SEEK BLACK TERROR! HE EES MY BABY! YOU GO HOME··· OR ELSE!
HEY!
YOU'RE PLAYING WITH DYNAMITE, PAL!
SORRY, OLD BOY ···BUT YOU ASKED FOR IT!
YAAAGGHH!
SOK!
PILOT TO BOMBARDIER ··· TAKE OVER!
I KNOW THIS GAG IS CORNY ···BUT IT WORKS!
OOOFF!
QUEECK! THE AMERICANO WEEL KEEL US!
TSK, TSK! WHAT'S WRONG WITH A LITTLE FUN?


AS THE DESPERADOES FLEE—
YOU FORGOT YOUR PISTOL, PUNK!
CONK!
EEEYOW!
...THE OLD INDIAN AWAKES!
VIVA AMERICANO! VIVA THE GOOD NEIGHBOR POLICY! HAH ---NOW YOU REAL FRAN' OF MEXICO---BECAUSE YOU MAKE DESPERADO KEES THE DUST!
THAT'S FINE, CHUM! THAT'S JUST DUCKY! BUT WHERE'S THE BLACK TERROR?
SEE? ME--DIEGO ROMERO---IS GOOD FRAN'! BUT POSITIVELY! LOOK--ON THEES ROAD MAP, HERE-- YOU FOLLOW THEES PATH, AND---
ROMERO--- WE'RE YOUR PALS FOR LIFE!
SHOULDN'T HAVE ANY TROUBLE FINDING THE PLACE NOW. LET'S GET GOING, BOB!
LATER THAT DAY---IN THE NEARBY FOOTHILLS---
OH-OH! OUR PAL ROMERO WAS ON THE BALL, TIM! IF THOSE TWO CHARACTERS WORE TERROR TWIN UNIFORMS---
---WE'D BE SEEING DOUBLE, EH? LET'S GO!
HERE COME THE TERROR TWINS!
SOMEBODY'S DUE FOR THE SURPRISE OF HIS LIFE!
AND IT WON'T BE US!


A moment later...
CARAMBA! IT EES THE B-BLACK TERROR···OR AM I SEEING DOUBLE?
COULD BE, PAL! NOW MAKE WITH THE EXPLANATION!
SPURS··· SOMBREROS··· NOW I'VE SEEN EVERY-THING!
I···PORFIRIO JUAREZ RIVERA···BOW MY STUPID HEAD IN SHAME! I AM JUST WHAT YOU THINK ···A BEEG PHONY!
OH, COME, NOW···IT'S NOT THAT BAD! LET'S TALK THINGS OVER!
MIGUEL AND I···WE BUY A MOVEENG PEECTURE PROJECTOR WEETH FILM! FILM, SHE EES CALLED···"THE BLACK TERROR"!
I'D LIKE TO MEET THE FELLA THAT WROTE THE SCRIPT!
RIVERA, I'M AFRAID YOU LET THAT FILM GIVE YOU "BEEG" IDEAS!
SI! BUT MIGUEL AND I··· WE SEE OUR BEAUTIFUL COUNTRY FULL OF BANDITS···SO WE BUY TERROR TWIN UNIFORMS! GOODBYE, BANDITS!
HERE EES THE FILM! SEE?
7


Next instant...
LOOK OUT!
BANG!
ZZZZZIP!
CRASH!
EET EES JOSE FERNANDO AND HEES BANDITS!
OH-OH! BROTHER RAT MUST'VE TRAILED US HERE FROM TOWN!
FOUR BLACK TERRORS! WHERE OTHER TWO COME FROM?
EES BEEG MEESTAKE ...SI?
NOW YOU'RE BUZZIN', COUSIN! YOUR MISTAKE!
YIPPEE! HERE WE GO AGAIN!
THEES TIME...JOSE FERNANDO WEEL NOT MISS!
PORFIRIO—GET TO TOWN AND BRING THE SHERIFF! WE'LL HANDLE JOSE FERNANDO AND HIS GANG!
I'LL HAVE TO PLANT YOU IN THE DESERT, YOU OLD CACTUS!
UGH!
BIFF!
AND I'LL HELP WITH THE SPADE-WORK!
I...MANUEL... FEEX HEEM ...BUT QUEECK!
8


TERROR! LOOK OUT···
KEEL HEEM! CRUSH HEEM INTO GROUND!
OHHHH!
KRAK!
BLACK TERROR SAY GO TO TOWN AND GET SHERIFF! EET EES ORDER!
SI, SEÑOR TERROR ···I MEAN, SEÑOR RIVERA!
AIEEE! THEY FLEE!
Next moment···
HAH! WE WEEL TAKE THESE FOOLS TO THE FOOTHILLS AND BURY THEM IN THE SAND ···UP TO THEIR NECKS!
VIVA JOSE FERNANDO!
WHEN TERROR COMES TO···
HUH? W-WHERE AM I···?
MOUNT, AMIGOS···AND RIDE THEES TWO AMERICANOS TO DEATH! LATER WE CATCH THOSE FAKE TERROR TWINS ALSO!
A DREADFUL ORDEAL!
TERROR! THE GROUND'S SHAKING···! I···I CAN'T STAND THESE AWFUL VIBRATIONS···!
COURAGE, TIM! IT'LL ALL BE OVER IN FIVE MINUTES···!
VIVA JOSE FERNANDO!
THUD!
THUD!
THUMMPPP!


And then···as a last resort···
HOLD ON, TIM! ALL I'VE GOT IS MY STRENGTH, BUT··· !
CRAKKK!
WITH A MIGHTY SURGE···
AH! THE SAND'S GETTING LOOSER ··· ANOTHER PUSH AND··
YRAAGGHHH!
THE EARTH SPLITS OPEN! THE BLACK TERROR RISES AND··
TIME TO SETTLE THE SCORE — BUT GOOD!
JOSE FERNANDO IS GETTING AWAY!
FIRST WE'LL TAKE YOU OUT OF THE GAME, MANUEL!
HALP!
POW!
YOUR TURN NOW, JOSE FERNANDO!
NEVER WEEL YOU CATCH JOSE FERNANDO! NEVER!
TERROR! HE'S DISLODGING THAT BOULDER! LOOK OUT!


WHEW! T-THAT WAS CLOSE!
AND DON'T I KNOW IT! WE'LL GET HIM NOW, TIM!
Moments after...
JOSE FERNANDO CANNOT BE TAKEN ALIVE!
TIM... THERE HE GOES!
SUDDENLY...
JOSE FERNANDO IS DESPERATE BANDITTO! HE WEEL NOT GO TO JAIL!
AIEEE! I AM CAUGHT! I HAVE MADE BEEG MISTAKE!
THIS IS A FINE TIME TO REALIZE THAT!
AMERICANO SAY STOP- YOU STOP! SI!
WELL, FOLKS...THAT JUST GOES TO SHOW THAT YOU NEVER KNOW WHEN A GOOD FRIEND WILL COME IN HANDY!
Later...IN RIVERA'S SHACK...
KEEP THE UNIFORM AS A SOUVENIR, PORFIRIO JUAREZ RIVERA! BUT BE CAREFUL WHEN YOU WEAR IT..
TERROR, YOU HAVE MADE ME SO PROUD ...SO HAPPY...!
AND YOU KEEP YOUR UNIFORM TOO, MIGUEL!
THANKS, AMIGO!
Don't miss the next issue! It's chock full of sure-fire BLACK TERROR Adventures!

CIRCUS LAD

By CHARLES S. STRONG

CLINTON MORGAN was realizing one of his greatest ambitions. He was going to get a job in the circus! It was going to be a fairly easy job at first, but later on, he might work up into a place in the act that his father and mother had made famous. The Riding Morgans were known to all circus folks as the best bareback riders in the business.

Clinton was in the office wagon talking things over with Vance Daly, owner of the big Daly Brothers Circus. "Thanks for giving me a start, Mr. Daly," Clinton said. "I know I'm going to like it here. I've heard nothing but circus from my mother and father ever since I was old enough to talk."

While the youth and the circus owner were talking they were suddenly interrupted by a masked man who walked into the wagon.

"Stick them up!" he ordered, waving a gun. "You've got a big crowd tonight, and I know that means real money in the till. I want it."

Clinton opened his mouth to shout the "Hey, Rube" that was the rallying cry for the circus men, but the gunman pushed the gun against him and said:

"One word out of you, and I'll blow you apart."

Daly hesitated for a moment, then pushed the money toward the robber. It was in two canvas bags, and the crook picked them up and backed out of the wagon.

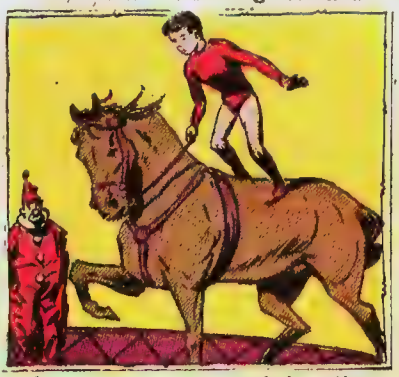
"I'll have one eye on the door," he said, "so don't get any funny ideas."

The boy and the circus owner waited for several minutes, then Clinton ran to the door. Daly picked up the telephone to call police. Suddenly there was a clatter of hoofs, and then Clinton shouted:

"He's getting away on one of the horses. He sure had this figured out all right."

"Pretty smart, all right," admitted Daly, hanging up the telephone after giving the alarm. "Let's get after him."

A number of the roustabouts were running toward



the wagon now, and hastily the boy and the man explained what had happened. A small runabout car was pressed into service and a half dozen of the group piled into it. It went out of the circus grounds and down the road in the wake of the running horse. About two blocks from the circus they saw the handsome gray animal standing at the side of the road.

"Quick thinking, all right," Clinton said. "He changed to a car here, and we have no idea of just what kind of a car he was using."

"We'll go ahead, anyway," Daly declared. "This is the only main road out of town, and the police will have a road block set up."

Sure enough, when they had gone about a mile further, at a point where the road branched off, there was a State Police road block. Half a dozen cars were lined up and the police were questioning the drivers.

Daly and the circus folks climbed out of their car and hurried forward. Three of the people being questioned were men who had been alone in their cars. Each one of them wore dark clothing and was of the medium height of the bandit.

"It's going to be a tough job picking out your suspect," the police sergeant declared. "Can you help us out, Mr. Daly?"

The circus man studied the three men for some signs of recognition, but he could spot nothing that he could definitely identify. Suddenly Clinton stepped forward and asked:

"Can I take a crack at it?"

"Sure thing," agreed the trooper. Clinton took a flashlight from one of the policemen and turned it on. Then he directed the beam at the legs of the three men. Suddenly he pointed to one of them and said: "He's the one. Grab him!"

The suspect stiffened at the accusation, then tried to dart away into the darkness. One of the troopers grabbed him and brought him back.

"How did you spot him?" Daly asked.

"Circus savvy," the boy replied. "All bareback horses have rosin on their backs to keep the rider from slipping. This fellow got the rosin on his trousers legs when he escaped from the circus grounds!"

Daly patted the boy on the shoulder. He'd make a good circus man!

Clinton Morgan Proves He Has Big Top Savvy!


the
BLACK
TERROR
1

Costume parties are always fun—but the shindig thrown by J. Mortimer Gates turned into a general riot when a gang of sharpies entered the picture with murder in their minds...and swept the *Black Terror* and *Tim* into a mad melee of daffiness, death and disaster!

"YOU'LL DIE LAUGHING!"



IN AN ABANDONED FACTORY—

"J. MORTIMER GATES, HEAD OF THE GATES DRUG CO., PLANS TO BUY EMPTY FACTORY ON STRATFORD ROAD!"

GOSH, GLOOM—WHAT'LL WE DO NOW?

AND YOU MUGS *WONDER* WHY I HAVEN'T LAUGHED FOR TEN YEARS—WITH BUM BREAKS LIKE *THAT!*

WITH OVER $200,000 IN LOOT STORED HERE—IT'LL BE EASIER TO BUMP OFF GATES THAN *MOVE!* TROT OUT AND PHONE HIS HOUSE, WILLIE—SEE IF HE'S HOME!


MINUTES LATER--
THE BUTLER SAYS GATES ISN'T HOME, GLOOM! HE'S BUSY PREPARING FOR A COSTUME PARTY ON HIS YACHT TONIGHT!
HMM--! WE CAN'T GO OUT AND RENT COSTUMES OPENLY--BUT STEALING 'EM MIGHT BE A BIG HELP!
THAT EVENING AT BOB BENTON'S DRUG STORE--
SEE THIS, BOB? DR. ANDREWS' YACHT "SENEGAL" HAS JUST ARRIVED FROM AFRICA WITH A CARGO OF ANIMALS FOR THE ZOO!
SOMEONE'S OUT FRONT! OH-OH--IT'S JEAN!
I'LL BET YOU'VE FORGOTTEN ALL ABOUT J. MORTIMER GATES' PARTY, BOB--AND YOU PROMISED TO TAKE ME!
I'VE BEEN BUSY WITH THIS EXPERIMENT ON ALDEHYDE DERIVATIVES, JEAN! HOPE IT ISN'T TOO LATE TO PICK UP COSTUMES!
SOON AFTERWARD--
NOTHING FANCY, GET ME? WE DON'T WANT TO LOOK LIKE A BUNCH OF TWERPS!
CRAK
WELL, WELL! OUR HOST IS GETTING RIGGED OUT HERE, TOO!
J. MORTIMER GATES
A GORILLA OUTFIT! NICE KNOWING WHAT GATES WILL BE WEARING TONIGHT!
AT THAT MOMENT--
CLOSED! THAT'S ONE EXCUSE FOR NOT GOING!
HOLD IT, TIM! THAT DOOR'S BEEN JIMMIED!
ACE COSTUMES
3


LOOKING FOR SOMETHING IN PRISON STRIPES, BOYS?
A COMEDIAN, EH? I JUST LOVE FUNNY PEOPLE!
TAKE YOUR PICK WHILE THEY LAST, TIM!
OH, I'M NOT CHOOSY!
POW
ZAM
GRAB ANYTHING-- AND LET'S GET OUT OF HERE!
WUP! GIVE ME ROOM, TIM!
JUST WAIT A SECOND, CHUMP-- AND YOU'LL HAVE THE WHOLE PLACE TO YOURSELF! DON'T FORGET A COSTUME FOR MUSCLES!
BANG!
WAK!
STRANGE THEY SHOULD STEAL COSTUMES JUST BEFORE GATES'S PARTY! MAYBE WE WILL GO, TIM-- IN OUR OWN OUTFITS!
AN HOUR LATER--
RATS! I WOULD HAVE TO PICK UP SOMETHING LIKE THIS!
YEH— LOOK AT ME!
4


MEANWHILE--ABOARD THE GATES YACHT--
I DECIDED AT THE LAST MINUTE, JEAN, THAT I WASN'T QUITE THE TYPE FOR A GORILLA COSTUME!
NOW THAT I AM EARLY, MR. GATES-- LET'S PLAN ENOUGH GAMES FOR A LIVELY EVENING!
PLENTY OF BOATS, GLOOM! HOW DO WE FIND GATES?
SEE THOSE MUGS IN COSTUME? THAT MUST BE IT!
SLAM 'EM BACK-- AND LET'S FIND GATES!
MY WORD! WHAT ARE YOU BOUNDERS UP TO? I'M DR. ANDREWS!
SOK!
MAYBE GATES IS IN HERE, GLOOM!
WHAM!
WELL, WELL-- IT'S THAT GORILLA COSTUME, EH? GREETINGS, GATES!
GUH!
WAIT, GLOOM! THERE'S A CAR COMING!
WE CAN'T TAKE A CHANCE ON GUNPLAY NOW! GET MOVING, YOU!


PROBABLY MORE GUESTS! KEEP UP THAT CORNY GORILLA ACT, GATES--AND KEEP YOUR YAP SHUT!
GET GATES INTO THE CAR! WE'LL JOB HIM AT THE FACTORY!
REMEMBER THEM? PILE OUT, TIM!
WITH A FACE LIKE THAT-- YOU SHOULD HAVE GRABBED A MASK, TOO!
POW!
BETTER STAND ASIDE, PAL--BEFORE YOU GET HURT!
WAM!
THE ROGUES ARE STEALING BONGO! QUICK, BOY-- MY ELEPHANT GUN!
TIM! GET DOWN!
BANG!
H-HEY! SOMEONE'S POTTIN' AT US WITH A CANNON!
6


SCRAM, MUGS-- BEFORE SOMEONE PULLS A DIVE-BOMBER!
NO USE TRYING TO CHASE THEM THROUGH A DOZEN WHARFS, TIM! OH-- MY HEAD--! WHO-EVER FIRED THAT CANNON SURE HELPED THE RATS!
GOSH, MR. GATES-- IT'S THE BLACK TERROR!
I SUSPECTED TROUBLE HERE, JEAN--AND FROM THE WAY THINGS LOOK, IT'S JUST STARTING!
DASH IT ALL--THAT GORILLA IS WORTH $10,000! WHAT'S MORE, HE'S A TOUCHY BRUTE!
FROM WHAT I HEARD, GATES--THEY MEANT TO KIDNAP YOU! WISH I KNEW WHICH FACTORY THEY WERE TAKING THE GORILLA TO!
COULD IT BE THE ONE I WAS PLANNING TO BUY ON STRATFORD ROAD?
THAT MAY BE THE TIE-UP! WE'LL HAVE A LOOK! AND WE'LL GET YOUR GORILLA BACK, DR. ANDREWS!
WHEW! I'M GOING BACK TO AFRICA! TOO MUCH EXCITEMENT HERE FOR ME
AT THE FACTORY--
O.K., WILLIE-- MIGHT AS WELL GET THIS OVER WITH!


GAK!
HEY!
NEVER MIND HORSIN' AROUND, GATES-- THIS IS SERIOUS! OW-LEGGO!
YUK! YUK! YUK!
I'M WARNING YOU, GATES! STOP ACTING LIKE A GORILLA! GLOOMY--THROW ME A GUN!
HOLY SMOKE-- TARZAN STUFF!
LOOK AT 'EM! I'VE MET FUNNY TYPES BEFORE-- BUT THIS GATES IS A CARD!
TRY TO MAKE A MONKEY OUTA ME, WILL YOU?
BOP!
BAM!
OH, HAW-HAW! TRY BITING HIM, MUSCLES!
CRRASH!


HA-YAH-YAH! IF I ONLY HAD A C-C-CAMERA!
IT'S MOVING! STOP IT, GLOOM-- STOP IT! THIS AIN'T FUNNY!
BR-RRRRP!
A MOMENT LATER--
YAH! HAW-HAW-HAW!
LISTEN! THAT MUST BE SOME JOKE!
OOOOPS!
CRASH!
NOW THERE WILL BE FUN, TERROR!
I'M NOT TOO SURE! BONGO'S MAD!
GRRRAGH!
POW!
TOO BAD YOU CAN'T RECOGNIZE FRIENDS, BIG FELLA!
YARRRGH!
TERROR! HE'LL BE KILLED, TIM!
BLAM!
9


COME ON AND FIGHT, YOU BIG PALOOKA! I DARE YOU!
STAND--BACK, TIM! I'VE--GOT SOMETHING!
BAM!
ATTA BOY-- TAKE A GOOD SNIFF!
AS THE PARALYZING GRIP RELAXES--
HAVEN'T TIME TO CROON YOU A LULLABY--BUT THIS SHOULD HELP!
POW!
CRASH!
INSIDE--
WHAT'S GOING ON, GLOOMY?
HA-HA! YOU MISSED IT, WILLIE! I JUST HAD THE BIGGEST LAUGH OF MY LIFE! HA! HA! HA!
HOW'S YOUR SENSE OF HUMOR HOLDING UP, RAT?
BETTER THAN THIS STOOGE OF HIS, I HOPE!
POW!
WAM!
SOKO!


HOW'S THIS FOR A "MASSACRE-ADE", MUGS?
POW!
BONK!
A MOMENT LATER--
WE JUST FOUND HEAPS OF LOOT INSIDE, TERROR!
THAT EXPLAINS PLENTY! WE'LL HAVE THE POLICE PICK IT UP WHEN THEY COME FOR THE GORILLA!
GORILLA! YOU MEAN THAT THING IS--IS--
A REAL GORILLA! HAW-HAW-- NO WONDER IT LOOKED GOOD!
PLOP!
NOW THAT WE'VE TAKEN JEAN HOME, TERROR--WHAT WAS IN THAT BOTTLE?
AT THE STORE I ABSENTMINDEDLY PUT A BOTTLE OF PARALDEHYDE IN MY POCKET! IT'S A POWERFUL HYPNOTIC --THE FUMES KNOCKED BONGO OUT!
NEXT DAY--
SO THE BLACK TERROR WAS AT GATES'S PARTY! ANY-THING HAPPEN, JEAN?
ALL HE DID THIS TIME WAS SAVE MR. GATES'S LIFE, FIND A FORTUNE IN STOLEN GOODS --AND CAPTURE THREE THUGS AND A GORILLA!
3 SPINE TINGLING BLACK TERROR ADVENTURES PLUS A BRAND NEW GUEST FEATURE IN THE NEXT ISSUE OF BLACK TERROR MAGAZINE! DON'T MISS IT!

SMUGGLER PLOT

By EDWARD HASSET

THE little fishing boat was bobbing up and down on the waters of the Strait of St. John de Fuca. Fred Gurney and his father were having a rough time of it. They had been out in the Pacific Ocean off Vancouver Island and the Olympian Peninsula of Washington, fishing for big game fish. Now it was dark, however, and they were picking their way along by the buoy lights.

George Gurney was at the wheel, and his son was listening to the radio. Suddenly one of the stations interrupted its regular program and said:

"The U. S. Coast Guard and the R.C.M.P. Marine Division are cooperating in an attempt to capture smugglers running goods into Vancouver and Seattle. Fishermen and steamboat captains are asked to report anything suspicious in this area to the nearest Coast Guard or Mounted Police station."

"Boy," said Fred briskly, "wouldn't that be something, if we could help catch the smugglers?"

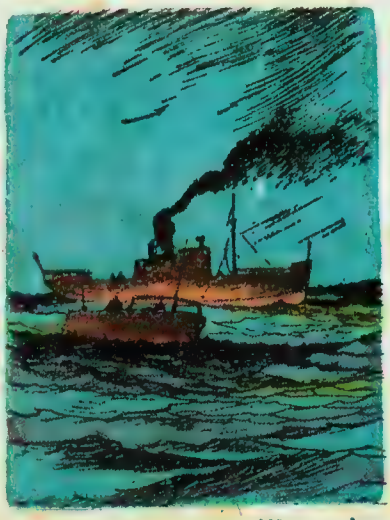
"Not tonight," laughed George. "I'm too tired, and I'll bet your mother is starting to worry about us."

The words were hardly out of the elder Gurney's mouth when a black shape loomed up above them, and Fred Gurney pulled the cord of the fog whistle. As the eerie moaning sound boiled out, a spotlight suddenly came to life on the bigger boat and caught them in its circle. The barrels of two rifles were pointed at them and a gruff voice shouted: "Stand by to come aboard, or we'll sink you!"

"It's the smugglers!" Fred said in a whisper. His father nodded.

The smuggling ship threw them a line, and moments later the boy and his father were aboard.

"Where are you heading?" asked a gruff voice. George Gurney told his destination, then the smuggler said: "Maybe you're all right, and then



again maybe not. We can't afford to take a chance."

Then the man, who was obviously in command, issued orders to two of his crew members. "Tie them up, and keep them in the corner here near the wheel where you can keep an eye on them. We know the Coast Guard is searching these waters, but the dumb sailors are too close in shore."

Fred and George were tied up. They saw the smuggling ship pull away from their fishing boat, leaving it adrift. George was thankful for this. The running lights were still on, and the Coast Guard would be bound to find it the next day.

Fred was down beside the binnacle. Even though his hands were tied, he was able to fumble in his hip pocket. After some moments he leaned forward a bit, and looked up at the bearded face of the man behind the wheel.

"Where are you heading?" he asked curiously.

"None of your business," replied the tough, "but it's due west!"

The captain came into the cabin and said: "We ought to be seeing their signal any minute. We're supposed to meet them just at daylight."

When day dawned, the bulk of a ship loomed up off the bow. "There it is!" shouted the captain. Suddenly, however, he gritted his teeth and cried: "By golly, it's a Government cutter. Full speed ahead!"

The men on the cutter were alert, however, and shells were soon popping over the bow of the smuggler ship. The captain and the crew moved out on deck with their hands in the air. As they went, the captain nudged the helmsman and asked:

"How did we get way off our course like this? We're not out in the ocean at all. We're down in Puget Sound!"

The sailor shook his head dumbly. Fred watched while a Coast Guardsman untied him and his father. Then he picked up a piece of iron he had used for a sinker on the fish boat and said:

"Maybe this had something to do with it. I set it down before the compass and it pulled the needle around. It sure helped trick you smugglers!"

The Coast Guardsmen laughed as they agreed with him.

Fred Gurney Matches Wits With Sea Criminals!


The BLACK TERROR
The Alchemist's dream--a formula to change any metal into gold--remained an unsolved mystery until brilliant Dr. Sloan began his search for it.... only to discover that danger and death can glitter like gold! But the flashing fists of the Black Terror... in reality the studious druggist, Bob Benton... shape the yellow metal into a "GOLDEN DOOM!"
CC-644
ONE MORNING, IN BOB BENTON'S DRUG STORE...
IT'S DR. SLOAN, THE NOBEL PRIZE WINNER IN CHEMISTRY! THAT MUST BE HIS NEPHEW!
WE'LL DISCUSS IT AT HOME, TOM! I WANT TO PICK UP SOME CHEMICALS!
PLEASE FILL THIS LIST OF CHEMICALS, BENTON! I'LL TAKE WHAT YOU HAVE ON HAND! YOU CAN SEND THE BALANCE TO MY LAB!
OF COURSE, DR. SLOAN!
BUT UNCLE JACK, I GOTTA HAVE SOME MONEY! ALL THE FELLOWS IN THE GANG HAVE PLENTY, AND I HAVEN'T GOT A NICKEL! THEY'RE WAITING FOR ME!


MY BUDGET IS PRETTY LOW, TOM! I HAVEN'T ANY EXTRA MONEY TO SPARE UNTIL MY CHECK COMES IN!
YOU'VE GOT PLENTY! HOW ABOUT ALL THAT GOLD YOU'RE MAKING?
LOOKS LIKE MY FRUSTRATED NEPHEW HAS LET THE CAT OUT OF THE BAG! I CAN TRUST YOU TO KEEP QUIET, BENTON! I THINK I'VE FOUND THE FORMULA TO SYNTHESIZE GOLD! I'VE MADE SOME, AND IT SEEMS GENUINE!
GREAT SCOTT! WHY, DR. SLOAN··· MEN HAVE BEEN SEARCHING FOR THAT FORMULA FOR CENTURIES!
I WANT TO MAKE ONE FINAL TEST, AND THAT'S WHY I NEED THOSE CHEMICALS! IF IT COMES THROUGH ALL RIGHT, I'M TURNING IT OVER TO THE GOVERNMENT! ONE OF THE KEYS TO THE SOLUTION WAS THE SPLITTING OF THE ATOM AS USED IN MAKING THE ATOMIC BOMB!
DID YOUR UNCLE GIVE YOU THE MONEY? COME ON··· WE'RE JUST IN TIME TO MAKE A MOVIE!
NO··· I DIDN'T GET A CENT! HE SAID HE'S BROKE!
HE DIDN'T HAVE ANY MONEY! BAH··· YOU'VE BEEN GIVING US A LOT OF HOOEY! YOU SAID HE WAS SO SMART, HE COULD MAKE GOLD!
HAW-HAW! HE CAN MAKE GOLD··· BUT HE HAS NO MONEY!
I TOLD YOU THE TRUTH! HE CAN MAKE GOLD! I SAW IT!
LAY OFF HIM, KIDS! MAYBE HE'S TELLING THE TRUTH, BUT HIS UNCLE IS FOOLING HIM! MAYBE IT'S NOT GOLD!
BUT IT IS, ROCKY! MY UNCLE TOLD ME ··· IT'S A SECRET AND HE CAN'T USE IT FOR HIMSELF! HONEST!
2


I KNOW YOUR UNCLE IS A PRETTY SMART APPLE, KID! TELL YOU WHAT ···I'M INTERESTED IN CHEMISTRY, TOO! SUPPOSE YOU SHOW ME THE GOLD HE MADE, AND I'LL GIVE YOU 100 BUCKS FOR YOURSELF! YOU KNOW ROCKS BARNICK KEEPS HIS WORD!
ONE HUNDRED DOLLARS! SURE! UNCLE ISN'T HOME NOW! YOU CAN SEE IT AND TELL THEM I WASN'T LYING!
WE'LL GO ALONG, EH, ROCKS?
POOL ROOM
At the laboratory...
THERE IT IS ···WASN'T I RIGHT?
GOLD! THE REAL THING! IF WE COULD GET THE FORMULA FOR THIS···
DR. SLOAN RETURNS!
WHO ARE YOU? WHAT ARE YOU DOING HERE?
THEY WANTED TO SEE YOUR GOLD, UNCLE, SO I···!
PIPE DOWN, KID! WE'RE HERE TO BUY YOUR GOLD. FORMULA, POP! LET'S TALK BUSINESS!
IT'S NOT FOR SALE! GET OUT!
YOU'LL CHANGE YOUR MIND IN A MINUTE! SOFTEN HIM UP, BOYS!
A PLEASURE!
HOW'S THIS FOR A STARTER!
OHHHH!
SOK!
STOP! YOU YELLOW BULLIES! LET HIM ALONE!
THAT OUGHT TO QUIET THE KID DOWN! LOOKS LIKE WE'LL HAVE TO BREAK SLOAN DOWN TOO, BEFORE HE'LL TALK TURKEY! WE BETTER TAKE 'EM TO MY PLACE! ONCE WE GET THAT FORMULA···WE'RE ON EASY STREET!
DON'T WORRY, BOGS! WE'LL GET IT!
CRACK!

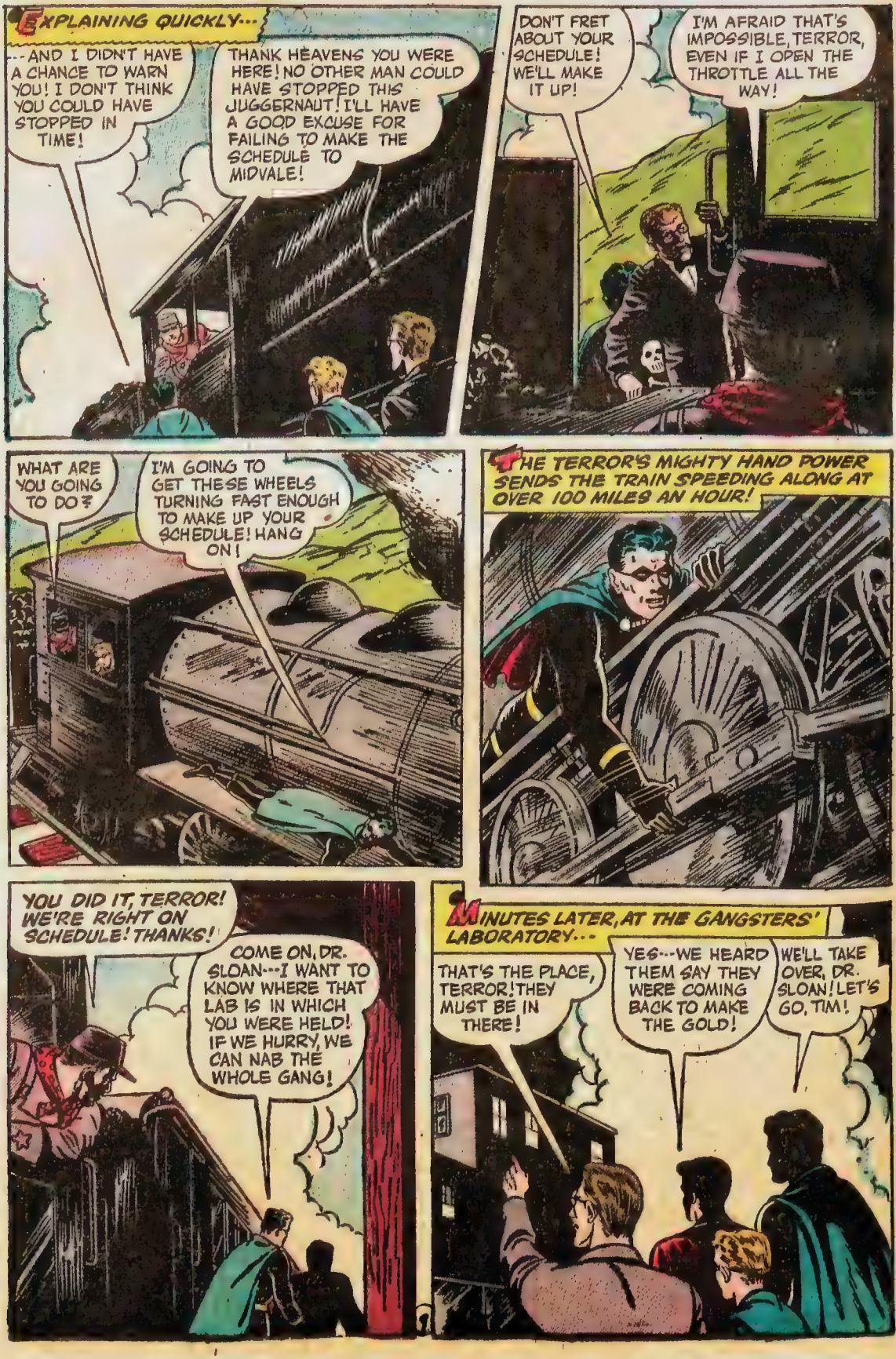

MEANWHILE, TIM DELIVERS THE BALANCE OF THE CHEMICALS FOR DR. SLOAN!
I'LL JUST LEAVE THESE AND HURRY BACK TO THE STORE! BOB AND I ARE DUE AT JEAN'S TONIGHT FOR DINNER!
OHHHH··· STOP··· PLEASE!
WHA···! DR. SLOAN!
GET THAT BRAT!
THE ONLY THING YOU RATS ARE GETTING IS THIS!
POW!
THAT CHIN DOESN'T FEEL SO··· UGHHH!
CRACK
THIS PUNK FIGHTS LIKE A WILDCAT!
OKAY···GET 'EM OUTTA HERE BEFORE SOMEBODY ELSE STICKS HIS NOSE IN! TAKE THE OLD BOY AND HIS KID!
HOW ABOUT THE DELIVERY KID? WHAT'LL WE DO WIT' HIM? HE'LL TALK WHEN HE COMES TO!
THROW HIM IN THIS REFRIGERATOR! HE'LL FREEZE TO DEATH! WHEN THEY FIND HIM, THEY'LL THINK IT WAS AN ACCIDENT! HE COULD HAVE BEEN POKING AROUND!
THAT'S A GOOD IDEA, ROCKS! WE'LL MAKE SURE HE COOLS OFF···PERMANENTLY!


LEFT TO A HORRIBLE DEATH---
LET'S GO!
BOB WAITS IMPATIENTLY FOR TIM---
WONDER WHAT'S KEEPING HIM! HE SHOULD HAVE BEEN HERE BY NOW! I GUESS I'LL WALK OVER TOWARD THE LAB AND PICK HIM UP!
AS BOB ARRIVES AT THE LAB---
HELLO---WHAT'S THIS? LOOKS LIKE SIGNS OF A FIGHT! I DON'T LIKE THIS! WONDER WHERE TIM IS? AND DR. SLOAN?
Suddenly---
WHAT'S THAT? COMING FROM THE REFRIGERATOR! MAYBE---GREAT SCOTT! COULD SOMEBODY BE IN THERE?
SCRATCH!
SCRATCH
COLD---MUST---LIE---DOWN---! MUST SLEEP! OHHH---!
SHEDDING HIS OUTER CLOTHES, MILD MANNERED BOB BENTON BECOMES---
LOOKS LIKE THIS IS A JOB FOR THE BLACK TERROR! HERE GOES!
MIGHTY MUSCLES STRAIN AGAINST THE MASSIVE REFRIGERATOR DOOR!
IT'S LOCKED---BUT ---THERE'S MORE THAN---ONE WAY TO ---OPEN A DOOR!
5

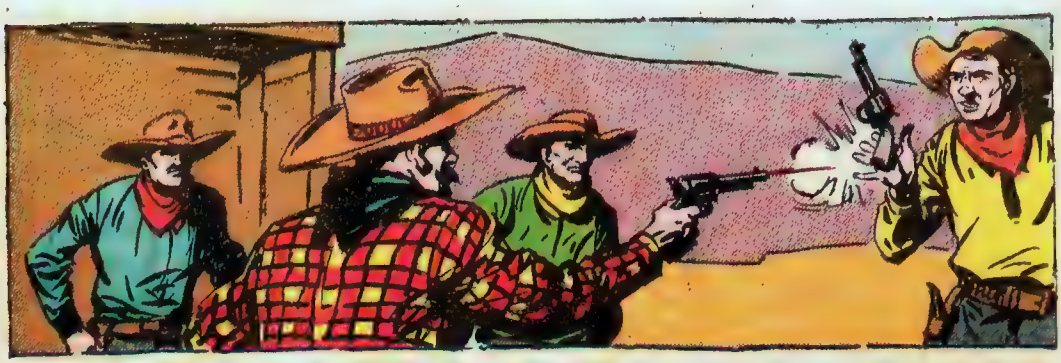

IT'S TIM!
RRRRRIPP!
HE DOESN'T SEEM TO BE RESPONDING! I'VE GOT TO GET PLENTY OF WARM AIR AROUND HIM TO THAW OUT HIS BODY, OR IT MAY BE TOO LATE!
TURNING ON A LAB HEATER, THE BLACK TERROR SEIZES THE HEAVY DOOR AND USES IT AS A FAN···
BY WAVING THIS, I MAY BE ABLE TO BLOW ENOUGH WARM AIR AROUND HIS BODY TO SAVE HIM!
AS THE WARM POCKET OF AIR SURROUNDS HIS BODY, TIM SLOWLY REGAINS CONCIOUSNESS!
YOU ALL RIGHT, TIM? WHAT HAPPENED?
ANOTHER FEW MINUTES IN THERE AND YOU WOULD HAVE BEEN MINUS A YOUNG PARTNER! I CAME IN HERE WITH THAT PACKAGE···
THAT'S ALL I REMEMBER AFTER I WAS SLUGGED! BUT I RECOGNIZED ONE AS ROCKS BARNICK!
ROCKS, EH? HE'S A BAD EGG, AND PROBABLY OUT FOR THAT FORMULA! HE'LL STOP AT NOTHING! LET'S GO···FIRST STOP IS ROCKS' APARTMENT AT THE DRAGON ARMS!
MINUTES LATER, LIKE TWO TORNADOES, THE TERROR TWINS CRASH INTO THE APARTMENT OF THE GANGSTER!
WE WANT SOMEBODY WITH A LOOSE TONGUE, AND WE'RE GOING TO START OILING IT UP!
AIEEE! THE BLACK TERROR!
CRASH!


DID I HEAR SOMEBODY SAY HE KNOWS WHERE ROCKS BARNICK TOOK DR. SLOAN?
AHAM!
POW!
TALK FAST...!
DON'T HIT ME...DON'T HIT ME! ROCKS TOOK HIM AND THE KID TO MIDVALE...THE NEXT TOWN! HE'S GOT 'EM IN A LAB ON MAIN STREET! THAT'S ALL I KNOW...HONEST!
THANKS FOR LOANING US YOUR BIKE, SON! WE'LL TAKE GOOD CARE OF IT! HAVE TO GET TO MIDVALE IN A HURRY!
GEE...THAT'S ALL RIGHT, TERROR! IT'S AN HONOR! YOU MEAN YOU'RE GOING ALL THAT WAY ON MY BIKE? GEE!
THE POWERFUL LEGS OF THE BLACK TERROR WHIP THE BICYCLE TOWARD MIDVALE AT A 70-MILE-AN-HOUR PACE!
I MUST BE SEEING THINGS! WHAT WAS THAT?
THE BLACK TERROR!
MEANWHILE, IN A SECLUDED LABORATORY IN MIDVALE...
THIS IS YER LAST CHANCE, SLOAN! UNLESS WE GET THE FORMULA, THAT ACID GOES IN THE KID'S EYES AND BLINDS HIM!
NO! NO! DON'T ... PLEASE! I'LL GIVE IT TO YOU!
DON'T GIVE IT TO THEM, UNCLE! THEY'RE BLUFFING...I THINK!
HERE'S THE FORMULA! NOW RELEASE US, AS YOU PROMISED!
AT LAST! WE'RE IN! ALL THE GOLD WE CAN MAKE!
SURE...WE'LL RELEASE YUH...RELEASE YUH TO THE GRAVE! TAKE 'EM DOWN TO THE TRACKS! THE CENTURY LIMITED IS DUE ANY MINUTE!
7


ROCKS---THIS IS A GOOD SPOT TO PUT 'EM! THE ENGINEER WON'T SEE 'EM UNTIL IT'S TOO LATE!
IT'S MURDER!
SO LONG, CHUMPS! GIVE MY REGARDS TO THE ANGELS! WE'RE ON OUR WAY BACK TO MAKE A TON OF GOLD!
MEANWHILE, THE TERROR TWINS RACE THE CENTURY FOR THE RAILROAD CROSSING---
STEP ON IT, TERROR! WE HAVE TO BEAT 'EM TO THE CROSSING OR WE'LL BE HELD UP!
HANG ON! I'M GOING TO GET A LITTLE MORE SPEED OUT OF THIS THING!
LOOK! THE BLACK TERROR'S RACING US! HE'S PASSING! DID WE SLOW DOWN?
NO---WE'RE DOING SEVENTY---AND HE'S ON A BIKE!
TERROR! LOOK! DR. SLOAN AND HIS NEPHEW!
GOOD HEAVENS! THEY'RE TIED! THE TRAIN'S COMING!
THERE'S NO TIME TO WARN THE TRAIN! I'LL HAVE TO STOP IT!
GO TO IT, TERROR! I'LL UNTIE THEM!
WHOA!


EXPLAINING QUICKLY···
---AND I DIDN'T HAVE A CHANCE TO WARN YOU! I DON'T THINK YOU COULD HAVE STOPPED IN TIME!
THANK HEAVENS YOU WERE HERE! NO OTHER MAN COULD HAVE STOPPED THIS JUGGERNAUT! I'LL HAVE A GOOD EXCUSE FOR FAILING TO MAKE THE SCHEDULE TO MIDVALE!
DON'T FRET ABOUT YOUR SCHEDULE! WE'LL MAKE IT UP!
I'M AFRAID THAT'S IMPOSSIBLE, TERROR, EVEN IF I OPEN THE THROTTLE ALL THE WAY!
WHAT ARE YOU GOING TO DO?
I'M GOING TO GET THESE WHEELS TURNING FAST ENOUGH TO MAKE UP YOUR SCHEDULE! HANG ON!
THE TERROR'S MIGHTY HAND POWER SENDS THE TRAIN SPEEDING ALONG AT OVER 100 MILES AN HOUR!
YOU DID IT, TERROR! WE'RE RIGHT ON SCHEDULE! THANKS!
COME ON, DR. SLOAN···I WANT TO KNOW WHERE THAT LAB IS IN WHICH YOU WERE HELD! IF WE HURRY, WE CAN NAB THE WHOLE GANG!
MINUTES LATER, AT THE GANGSTERS' LABORATORY···
THAT'S THE PLACE, TERROR! THEY MUST BE IN THERE!
YES···WE HEARD THEM SAY THEY WERE COMING BACK TO MAKE THE GOLD!
WE'LL TAKE OVER, DR. SLOAN! LET'S GO, TIM!


ARE WE INTERRUPTING SOMETHING?
THE BLACK TERROR!
THIS OUGHT TO HELP YOU SEE SOME GOLD STARS!
MY, MY--- NO REGISTANCE! TRY SOME VITAMINS!
THIS IS THE LAST ACT, RATS! YOUR LITTLE CELLS ARE WAITING!
I'LL FIX HIM!
SMACK!
HERE'S A SPECIAL CHIN STRETCHER I'VE BEEN SAVING FOR YOU!
THERE THEY ARE, OFFICER!
AS THE POLICE TAKE OVER---
I OWE MY LIFE TO YOU, TERROR--BUT I REALIZE NOW THAT IF THIS GOT INTO THE WRONG HANDS, IT WOULD UNDERMINE OUR ECONOMY! I'M TEARING IT UP AND TAKING THE SECRET TO THE GRAVE WITH ME!
THERE'S YOUR FORMULA, DR. SLOAN! THEY DIDN'T GET A CHANCE TO USE IT! WHAT ARE YOU GOING TO DO NOW?
SEVERAL HOURS LATER, AT JEAN'S HOUSE---
---AND THEN THE BLACK TERROR HELPED ROUND THEM UP! DR. SLOAN TOLD ME THE WHOLE STORY!
I SUPPOSE YOU GET YOUR THRILLS BY LISTENING TO THOSE STORIES, BOB, BUT I WISH I WERE THERE WITH THE BLACK TERROR! HE'S MARVELOUS!
ANOTHER THRILLING, ACTION-PACKED STORY WITH THE ONE AND ONLY BLACK TERROR IN OUR NEXT HAIR-RAISING ISSUE!



LUCKY FOR THE LAW

By DONALD BAYNE HOBART

A STRANGE hush hung over Longhorn. Though it was early in the afternoon, the single street of the little cowtown was deserted. In the lot behind the jail and sheriff's office, Danny Cooper stopped pitching horseshoes with the old stablekeeper. The man and the boy looked at each other.

"Guess they'll be riding into town any time now," said Seth Larkin. "The Rand brothers are tough hombres. We better go out on the street and see what happens, Danny."

"Dad isn't afraid of the Rands," Danny said as he walked beside Larkin along the side of the building toward the dusty street of the town. "He's the best sheriff this county ever had."

As he walked Danny found he was still carrying the horseshoe he had been about to pitch. The boy glanced at it and then smiled at the stablekeeper.

"Maybe it will bring Dad luck," Danny said. "I shore hope so."

On the plank walk in front of the office Sheriff Matt Cooper stood waiting. The Rand brothers were rustlers and the sheriff had driven them out of town some months ago. But they had sent word to the lawman that they were coming in to kill him. Now Cooper was awaiting the two ruthless gunmen who had boasted that no one could beat them on the draw.

"They're coming," Larkin said.

A dust cloud had risen on the road south of the town. Riders were approaching and coming fast. Danny and Larkin stood in the entrance of the alley between the sheriff's office and the feed store and watched and waited tensely.

In a few minutes the Rand brothers approached. They were both big hard-faced men. They dismounted and fastened their horses' reins to the hitching-rail across the street from the sheriff's office. Buck Rand walked across the street and then halted and stood facing the sheriff, his hand close to his gun.

"I told you two to get out of this part of the country," said the sheriff coldly. "I know you've been doing the rustling."

"And we don't like to be accused," snapped Buck Rand. "We aim to do somethin' about it here and now."

Joe Rand walked over so that he was standing to one side of the sheriff. He paid no attention to the old man and the boy who watched from the alley. Danny noticed that the Rand brothers had maneuvered their positions so that it would be hard for the sheriff to watch both of them at the same time.

"All right," shouted Buck Rand suddenly. "This is it, Sheriff!"

He grabbed for his gun, but the sheriff swiftly shot him in the right arm. Buck Rand howled in pain and dropped his weapon.

Behind Cooper, Joe Rand snatched out his Colt and aimed at the broad back of the lawman.

Abruptly Danny's arm came up. He flung the horseshoe he had been holding and it hit Joe Rand's gun and knocked the weapon out of the man's hand.

"Trying to shoot me in the back, eh," said the sheriff, as he whirled and covered Joe Rand with his gun. "Good thing my son threw that horseshoe when he did!"

Riders came galloping into town.

They annouced that they had found stolen cattle hidden on the Rand's ranch.

"I was sure right when I accused you of being rustlers," said the sheriff. "And Danny here made a ringer when he helped me capture you!"

Young Danny Cooper beamed with pride.

The Sheriff's Son Pitches in to Help Justice!


The SCARAB
OUT OF THE MYSTIC ORIENT OF CENTURIES GONE BY... INTO THE MATTER-OF-FACT WORLD OF TODAY... A STRANGE LEGEND TAKES SHAPE AND BECOMES A WEIRD MENACE TO ALL MANKIND! ONLY ONE LIVING BEING CAN STOP IT ... THE SCARAB, REINCARNATION OF THE HIGH PRIEST OF THE EGYPTIAN SUN GOD... GIVEN WONDROUS POWERS FOR THE ETERNAL FIGHT AGAINST EVIL!
The FOUR THIEVES OF AM-RE!
This is a GUEST FEATURE
CC-342


YOUNG ARCHEOLOGIST PETER WARD HEARS A STRANGE TALE FROM AN OLD-EGYPTIAN!
AND IT IS SAID, EFFENDI WARD, THAT THERE WERE FOUR ARAB BRIGANDS WHO SOUGHT TO LOOT THE TOMB OF THE PHARAOH AM-RE, IN THE YEAR 1445!
THEY THOUGHT TO FIND WONDERFUL JEWELS, BUT INSTEAD THEY FOUND DEATH! AND YET··· IT WAS NOT DEATH!
"THE TOMB HAD BEEN LOST FOR CENTURIES, AND THEY CAME UPON IT PURELY BY CHANCE!"
MY BROTHERS, OUR SEARCH FOR WATER HAS LED US TO THE PRIZE OF PRIZES! THIS IS THE TOMB OF AM-RE··· AND LEGEND TELLS US IT IS FILLED WITH FABULOUS JEWELS!
YOU ARE RIGHT, AHMED! WE HAVE BEEN BEGGARS AND THIEVES··· NOW WE SHALL BE KINGS!
"BUT THEIR SEARCH UNCOVERED NO LOOT!"
WE HAVE WASTED OUR TIME! THE LEGEND WAS FALSE··· UNLESS··· PERHAPS ···THERE IS A SECRET TREASURE ROOM!
THIS PARCHMENT I FOUND, AHMED··· MAYHAP IT TELLS OF THE SECRET ROOM!
NO···NOT A SECRET ROOM, BUT SOMETHING FAR STRANGER··· A SECRET POTION OF WEIRD POWER! IT IS HIDDEN IN THE SARCOPHAGUS OF AM-RE!


THE PARCHMENT TELLS THAT THIS POTION WAS PRODUCED BY THE PHARAOH'S WISE MEN, TO GIVE HIM THE GIFT OF SLEEP··· FOR FIVE HUNDRED YEARS! THEN HE WAS TO RISE AND RESUME LIFE!
BUT THERE IS NO RECORD THAT AM-RE EVER ROSE AGAIN!
NO··· FOR THE PARCHMENT SAYS HE WAS ASSASSINATED, BEFORE HE COULD DRINK IT! THE POTION WAS PLACED IN HIS TOMB!
WHAT WAS THAT?
CREAK!
FOOTSTEPS! QUICKLY··· WE HIDE!
"The NEWCOMERS WERE MEMBERS OF AN ANCIENT SECRET TRIBE OF RELIGIOUS FANATICS, SWORN TO BUT ONE PURPOSE IN LIFE··· PROTECTION OF THE TOMB OF AM-RE!"
THEIR FOOTSTEPS IN THE DUST SHOW THAT THEY WERE FOUR··· AND THEY CAME THIS WAY!
THEY SHALL PAY WITH THEIR LIVES FOR DISTURBING THE HOLY PRIVACY OF AM-RE!
ANOTHER PASSAGE! QUICKLY ···FOLLOW ME!
FOLLOW! THEIR FOOTPRINTS SHOW THEIR PATH OF EVIL!


WE MUST ESCAPE ···OR DIE! FASTER, MY BROTHERS!
"BUT IT WAS A BLIND ALLEY···AND LED TO A BLANK WALL!"
WE ARE TRAPPED! WE HAVE NO CHOICE BUT TO DIE FIGHTING OR···NO! WAIT!
THE PHARAOH'S POTION! WE MUST EACH DRINK OF IT! THAT IS OUR ONLY ESCAPE··· ESCAPE INTO THE FUTURE!
AND WHEN THE PROTECTORS OF THE SACRED TOMB CAME UP...
HOW IS THIS? THEY ARE AS DEAD!
THE COWARDLY DOGS DRANK POISON, TO ESCAPE OUR JUST VENGEANCE! SEE!
IN AM-RE'S TIME, IT WAS THE CUSTOM TO BURY SLAVES WITH THEIR MASTER, THAT THEY MIGHT SERVE HIM IN THE AFTER-WORLD AS IN LIFE!
LET US DO THE SAME WITH THESE VILE ONES···AND THUS FORCE THEM TO SERVE THE GREAT ONE WHOSE TOMB THEY SOUGHT TO DEFILE!


AND THE LEGEND SAYS THE FOUR EVIL BRIGANDS ARE TO ARISE FROM THEIR SLEEP THIS VERY YEAR··· NAY, THIS VERY MONTH!
SAY, THAT'S INTERESTING! ASIDE FROM THE LEGEND, AM-RE'S TOMB IS SUPPOSED TO CONTAIN IMPORTANT HISTORICAL MATERIAL!
BUT NO ONE TODAY KNOWS WHERE IT IS!
YOUR PARDON, EFFENDI ··· I KNOW WHERE IT IS! I DISCOVERED IT MANY YEARS AGO, BUT THOUGHT IT BETTER KEPT SECRET STILL A WHILE LONGER! NOW, I AM VERY OLD AND HAVE LITTLE LONGER TO LIVE··· SO I WILL TELL YOU HOW TO FIND IT, IF YOU SO DESIRE!
AT THE HEAD OF AN EXPEDITION···
WE'VE BEEN SEARCHING NOW FOR WEEKS! ARE YOU SURE THE WHOLE STORY ABOUT THE AM-RE TOMB WASN'T A MYTH, WARD?
PERSONALLY, I BELIEVE IT IS TRUE, BUT··· LOOK! THERE'S THE STONE MARKER I WAS TOLD TO LOOK FOR!
FORTY FEET NORTH-EAST OF THE MARKER ···HERE'S WHERE WE'RE SUPPOSED TO DIG!
WE'VE FOUND IT··· THE SECRET ENTRANCE TO THE TOMB OF AM-RE! COME ON!


THIS IS THE MAIN ROOM! THE LARGEST SARCOPHAGUS MUST CONTAIN THE REMAINS OF AM-RE!
THERE'S A STRANGELY WEIRD ATMOSPHERE ABOUT THIS PLACE! OF COURSE, I DON'T BELIEVE THAT NONSENSE ABOUT THE ARAB BRIGANDS RETURNING TO LIFE, BUT...
Then...AS THOUGH THEY HEARD THE WORDS...
MERCIFUL HEAVENS! LOOK!
THE ARAB BRIGANDS! THEN THE STORY WAS TRUE!
DEPRAVED BY THE STRANGE DRUG IN THEIR VEINS... MADDENED AT THE SIGHT OF INTRUDERS IN THE TOMB WHOSE RICHES THEY SOUGHT TO KEEP FOR THEMSELVES ... THE ARABS ATTACK FIENDISHLY!
THE JEWELS ARE OURS! NO OTHERS MAY HAVE THEM! DIE, PRYING DOGS!
AGH!
PULL UP, YOU BEGGARS, OR... WHAT THE...! HE DOESN'T EVEN FEEL THE BLOW! THE POTION MUST HAVE MADE THEM IMMUNE TO INJURY!
THIS CALLS FOR THE SCARAB... BUT I CAN'T TRANSFORM MYSELF WITHOUT REVEALING MY SECRET! I'VE GOT TO TRICK THEM!
HOLD, FOOLS! YOU'LL NEVER FIND THE TREASURE UNLESS AKH-TU-MEN, MY SACRED CAT, SHOWS THE WAY!


DEEP IN THE TOMB...
COME WITH US, MASTER OF THE SACRED CAT! THE OTHERS REMAIN HERE!
IT IS TRUE! HE HAS THE SACRED MARKINGS!
THROUGH DARK AND DEVIOUS PASSAGEWAYS TO—
ALLAH BE PRAISED! THE HIDDEN TREASURE ROOM!
GOLD! JEWELS! THE WEALTH OF THE PHARAOHS!
YOU HAVE WHAT YOU SEEK!
NOW'S MY CHANCE TO TRANSFORM MYSELF INTO THE SCARAB! RING...BETTER DO YOUR STUFF...
A RUB OF THE MAGIC RING...A BOOMING EXPLOSION...AND THERE APPEARS...THE MIGHTY SCARAB!
MERCIFUL ALLAH! IT IS HE-WHO-FIGHTS EVIL! FLEE FOR YOUR LIVES!
THAT IS WHY HE HAD THE SACRED CAT!
HELP!


HOLD, COWARDLY DOGS! THE SCARAB POSSESSES STRANGE POWERS··· BUT SO DO WE! WE HAVE DRUNK OF THE MAGIC POTION, AND ARE NOT AS OTHER MEN! WE CAN RESIST HIM!
AHMED IS RIGHT, MY BROTHERS! TURN AND FIGHT!
DEATH TO THE SCARAB! NONE SHALL STAND IN OUR WAY!
I'M IN YOUR WAY RIGHT NOW··· AND I INTEND TO STAY IN YOUR WAY!
THIS IS FOR THE CRIMES YOU COMMITTED FIVE HUNDRED YEARS AGO··· AND FOR THE CRIMES YOU WOULD LIKE TO COMMIT TODAY!
MY KNIFE··· HE FELT IT NOT!
SCARAB! YIELD··· OR THE SACRED CAT DIES!
MEOW!
IF YOU CANNOT DEFEAT ME FAIRLY, YOU WILL DO IT FOULLY! VERY WELL! I HAVE NO CHOICE BUT TO YIELD!
TIE HIM TO THAT PILLAR··· AND TIE HIM SO TIGHTLY THAT EVEN THE MIGHTY SCARAB CANNOT ESCAPE!
VERY FLATTERING!


WE SHALL FORCE HIM TO REVEAL THE SECRETS OF THE SCARAB ...SECRETS THAT WILL MAKE US THE MOST POWERFUL MEN IN THE WORLD! BUT FIRST...WE MUST DISPOSE OF HIS COMPANIONS!
ALONE IN THE TREASURE ROOM...
I'VE GOT TO GET FREE, AKH-TU...OR EVERY MEMBER OF THE EXPEDITION WILL BE KILLED! BUT I CAN'T ...BREAK THESE BONDS!
THERE'S ONLY ONE WAY OUT ...LEVITATION!
A POWERFUL UPWARD SURGE, AND...
MADE IT!
CRASH!
I ONLY HOPE I'M IN TIME! IF THOSE KILLERS HAVE DONE THEIR DIRTY WORK...
AS THE SCARAB ENTERS THE TOMB...
NO USE TACKLING THE FOUR THIEVES RIGHT NOW... THEY CAN'T BE HURT BY ORDINARY MEANS. BUT HOW CAN THEY BE MASTERED?


IN THE TREASURE ROOM...
THERE MUST BE SOME ANSWER TO THE RIDDLE OF WHAT TO DO WITH THOSE FOUR ARABS!... I WONDER WHAT'S ON THIS SCROLL! AND HERE'S A VIAL OF CHEMICALS BESIDE IT!
IT SAYS: "FOR EVERY UNUSUAL POWER, THERE MUST BE A CHECK!" THEN THIS VIAL MUST CONTAIN CHEMICALS TO COUNTERACT THE POTION THOSE FOUR TOOK!... IT'S TIME I BECAME PETER WARD AGAIN!
AS PETER RETURNS TO THE MAIN ROOM...
THE FOUR THIEVES! IF THIS MYSTERIOUS POTION DOESN'T WORK— GOOD NIGHT!
HERE'S SOME MAGIC IN REVERSE!
WEIRD TRANSFORMATION!
MY BROTHERS! WE ARE AS ORDINARY MEN ONCE MORE! OUR IMMORTAL POWERS ARE GONE! AND WE ARE ALIVE IN A WORLD OF WHICH WE KNOW NOTHING! WE HAVE NO CHOICE BUT TO...
WE FOLLOW, AHMED!
AGHHH!
HEAVEN ONLY KNOWS WHAT CRIMES THEY MIGHT HAVE COMMITTED, HAD NOT THE SCARAB APPEARED TO THWART THEM!
YOU HAD A NARROW ESCAPE, WARD! IT WAS LUCKY YOU DISCOVERED THAT CHEMICAL!
THE SCARAB FOUND IT, NOT I! I WONDER WHAT BECAME OF HIM!
A GUEST FEATURE... A BONUS... APPEARS IN EVERY ISSUE OF BLACK TERROR Don't miss the next issue for another amazing story!

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Supply Limited! Clip This Coupon and Mail!

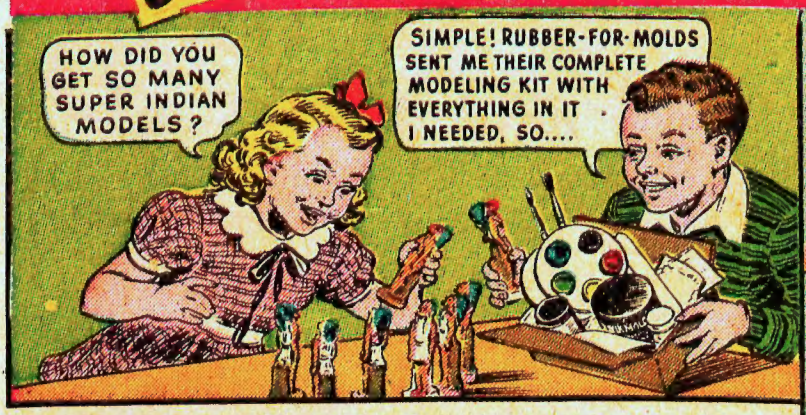
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CHECK ONE
☐ I am enclosing $3.98. Please ship postpaid.
☐ Ship C.O.D. I'll pay postman $3.98 plus postage.

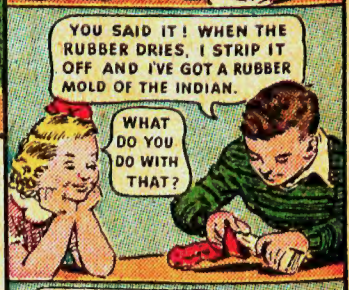
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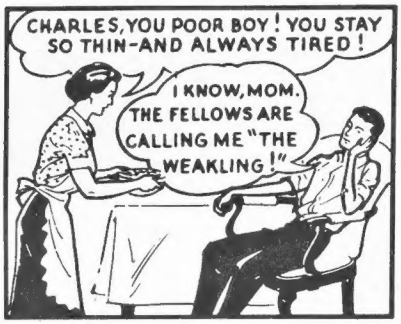
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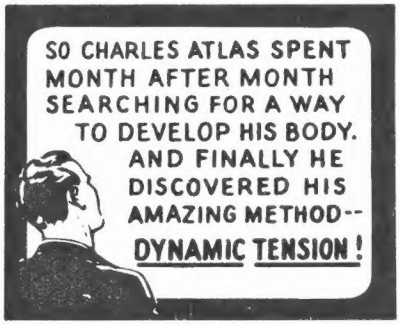
HOW A 97-Lb. WEAKLING Became the "WORLD'S MOST PERFECTLY DEVELOPED MAN"

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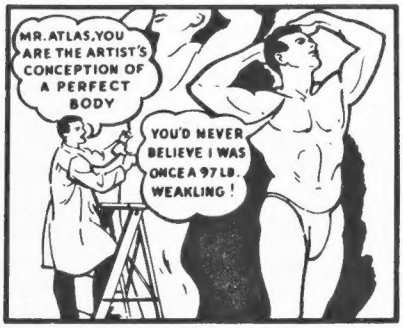


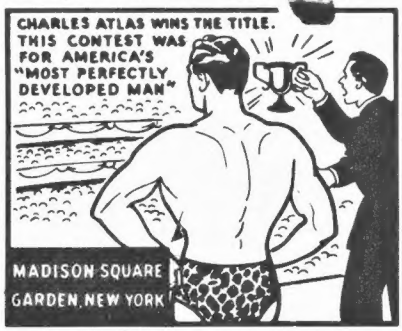


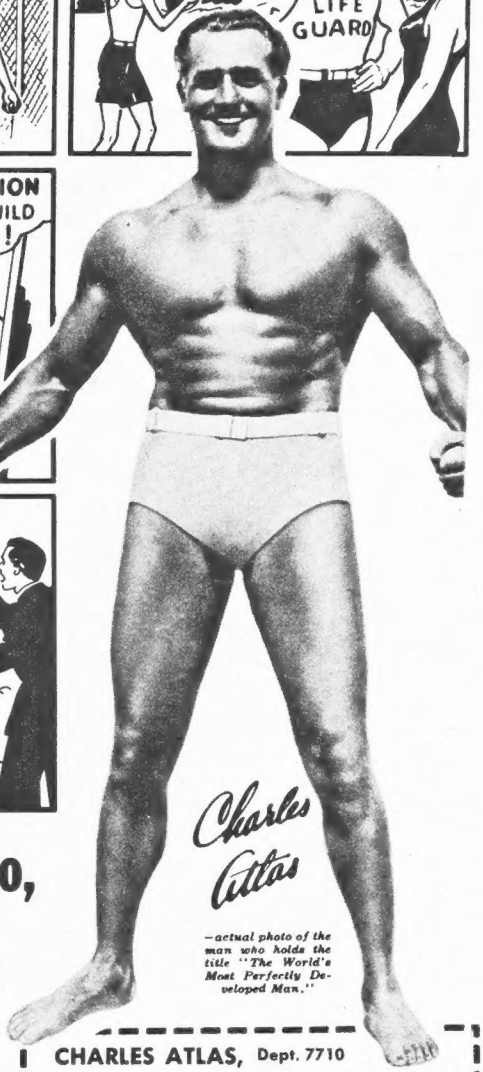












Charles Atlas

—actual photo of the man who holds the title "The World's Most Perfectly Developed Man."

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If you're the way I USED to be—if you are skinny and feel only half-alive—if the better jobs pass you by—if you're tired of being "pushed around"—if you're ashamed to strip for sports or a swim—and if you want a HE-MAN's body—then give me just 15 minutes a day! I'll PROVE you can have a build you'll be PROUD of! "*Dynamic Tension*" will do it for *you*, too! *That's* how I changed my own build into such perfect proportions that famous sculptors and artists have paid me to pose for them. My body won me the title, "World's Most Perfectly Developed Man." And now I can give you solid, beautiful, USEFUL muscle wherever YOU want it!

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